A light, colorful soup with quite a kick from the jalapeño. Large turnips have a stronger flavor, which is perfect for this dish. Don't use delicate baby ones.

spicy turnip soup with pimento and noodles

SERVES 4–6 **PREP** 10 MINS **COOK** 30 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS
AT THE END OF STEP 1

4 scallions, chopped
2 good-sized turnips, diced
½ tsp crushed hot red pepper flakes
1 green jalapeño pepper, seeded and cut into thin rings
2 star anise
2 tsp tomato purée
1 quart (1 liter) hot vegetable stock or light chicken stock
1 package dried thin Chinese egg noodles
1 preserved pimento, drained and diced
1–2 tsp soy sauce, to taste
freshly ground black pepper
small handful of cilantro, torn

1 Put the scallions, turnips, pepper flakes, jalapeño, star anise, tomato purée, and stock in a saucepan and bring to a boil. Lower the heat, partially cover with a lid, and simmer gently for 30 minutes or until the turnips are very tender. Discard the star anise.

2 Meanwhile, put the noodles in a bowl, cover with boiling water, and let stand for 5 minutes, stirring to loosen, then drain. Stir the noodles into the soup, along with the pimento. Season to taste with soy sauce and freshly ground black pepper, then stir in half the cilantro. Ladle into warm soup bowls, top with the remaining cilantro, and serve.



TURNIPS
Choose organic turnips for the sweetest, most mustardy flavor. To prepare, trim. Small turnips then need only the thinnest layer of skin peeled off. Larger turnips, however, usually have a thicker layer of hard woody skin to peel.